

DIGI-FIN LITERACY AFRICA

8 Dimensions of Digital Financial Literacy

Know exactly where you stand — and what to work on next. A practical self-assessment for university students and young professionals.

FREE DOWNLOAD | 8 pages

digifinliteracyafrica@gmail.com | [@digi.fin.literacy.africa](https://www.instagram.com/digi.fin.literacy.africa)

What Is Digital Financial Literacy?

True digital financial literacy is not just knowing how to use M-Pesa. It is a set of 8 interlocking skills — from understanding how digital products work, to protecting yourself from fraud, to making decisions that align with your goals. Assess yourself honestly on each dimension below.

#	Dimension	Core Question
1	Digital Financial Knowledge	Do I understand how the platforms I use actually work?
2	Digital Financial Risk Control	Am I protecting my accounts with strong security habits?
3	Consumer Rights & Redress	Do I know my rights — and how to claim them?
4	Practical Application	Can I confidently use a full range of digital financial tools?
5	Digital Financial Behaviour	Do my daily habits grow my wealth or drain it?
6	Self-Protection	Have I built a personal shield against digital fraud?
7	Digital Financial Decision Making	Do my money decisions align with my long-term goals?
8	Inclusive Access & Numeracy	Can I read, calculate, and access digital finance confidently?

Dimension 1 — Digital Financial Knowledge

Knowledge is the foundation of everything else. Before you can protect or invest your money, you need to understand how the products you use actually work — their fees, limits, risks, and terms. In Kenya, this means knowing how Fuliza charges daily interest, what happens when a mobile loan defaults, and how to evaluate new fintech products critically.

REAL STORY

Brian (23, Nairobi) used Fuliza regularly without understanding its daily interest model. After borrowing KSh 3,000, he owed KSh 3,900 two months later. Once he understood the product, he used it only for genuine emergencies and cleared balances within 24 hours.

Key insight: Understanding the product before you use it saves you from hidden costs.

Your Action Steps

1. List the three digital financial tools you use most. Research: how do they make money? What do they charge you? Where can you dispute errors?
2. Follow one verified financial literacy account this week (e.g. @digi.fin.literacy.africa).

Dimension 2 — Digital Financial Risk Control

Earning money digitally is only worthwhile if you can keep it safe. Risk control is both a technical skill and a daily discipline. Every time you click a link in an SMS, log into banking on public Wi-Fi, or share your OTP, you are making a risk decision — consciously or not.

REAL STORY

Aisha (26, Mombasa) received a convincing Safaricom phishing SMS warning her account would be suspended. She almost clicked — then paused, called the official line (100), and confirmed it was a scam. Her savings were safe.

Key insight: Pause before you click. Always verify through official channels — not through the link itself.

Your Action Steps

1. Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on at least one financial account today.
2. Change any password you have not updated in six months.
3. Save your bank's official fraud number in your contacts right now.

Dimension 3 — Consumer Rights & Redress

Many people do not know they have legal rights as digital financial service users — and scammers rely on this ignorance. In Kenya, digital consumers are protected by the Central Bank of Kenya (CBK), the Communications Authority, and the Consumer Protection Act. If you are charged incorrectly, you have the right to dispute and seek redress.

Your Action Steps

1. Look up and save the official complaint contacts for your bank and mobile money provider.
2. Read the terms and conditions of one financial product you use regularly this week.

Dimension 4 — Practical Application

Knowledge means nothing if you cannot apply it. Practical application is the bridge between theory and your financial life. This means confidently opening savings accounts via apps, sending international transfers, using digital receipts, and comparing platforms before transacting.

REAL STORY

Grace (21, Kisumu) was losing 8% in conversion fees when receiving freelance payments. After learning about direct M-Pesa international transfer options and Flutterwave alternatives, she reduced her transfer cost to under 3%.

Key insight: Knowing your options puts money back in your pocket. Always compare before you transact.

Your Action Steps

1. Try one digital financial task you have never done before this week — e.g. open a savings account on M-Shwari or compare transfer fees between two international remittance platforms.
2. Watch the official tutorial for a platform you want to use.

Dimension 5 — Digital Financial Behaviour

You can know everything about finance and still make poor decisions. Behaviour is the bridge between knowledge and outcomes. Positive habits include tracking income and expenses regularly, saving before spending, and reviewing statements monthly. Negative habits — like using Fuliza for unnecessary purchases or impulse-buying on TikTok — silently drain wealth.

REAL STORY

Kevin (25, Nairobi) was broke by the 15th of every month despite a stable salary. Tracking his M-Pesa transactions revealed KSh 7,000/month in food delivery and impulse online shopping. Three months after tracking, he cut this to KSh 2,000 and saved KSh 5,000 monthly.

Key insight: You cannot manage what you do not measure. Tracking changes everything.

Your Action Steps

1. Download your last 30 days of M-Pesa or bank transactions and identify your three largest non-essential spending categories.
2. Set up one automatic savings rule — even KSh 100/day adds KSh 3,000/month.

Dimension 6 — Self-Protection

Self-protection is about actively building a personal shield against digital threats — not just understanding them in theory. Your first line of defence is your habits: locking your SIM, never sharing OTPs, auditing app permissions, and knowing what to do within minutes of suspecting fraud.

Your Action Steps

1. Complete a quick audit: Settings → Apps → Permissions. Remove any app access you do not recognise.
2. Tick off every item on the Self-Protection Audit checklist on the next page.

Dimension 7 — Digital Financial Decision Making

Every day you make dozens of small digital financial decisions. Strong decision-making means aligning choices with your goals, pausing before non-essential purchases, comparing options, and asking 'who benefits from this?' before any investment or loan. Use the STOP framework to slow down high-stakes moments.

Your Action Steps

1. Write down your top three financial goals for the next 12 months.
2. Apply the STOP framework (Stop, Think, Options, Proceed) to your next three digital purchases.

Dimension 8 — Inclusive Access & Numeracy

Digital finance does not serve everyone equally. Barriers include limited smartphone access, difficulty reading financial terms in English, struggles with interest calculations, or lacking a formal ID. Recognising these barriers — in yourself and your community — is the first step to addressing them.

Your Action Steps

1. Identify one person in your life who would benefit from digital financial literacy support. Commit to sharing one tip or resource with them this week.
2. If someone in your network struggles with mobile money, offer to walk them through one task.

Your Digital Financial Literacy Scorecard

Rate yourself honestly from 1 (not at all confident) to 5 (very confident). Be honest — this is for you, not for anyone else.

#	Dimension	My Score (1-5)
1	I understand the fees, limits, and risks of the digital tools I use	___ / 5
2	I have 2FA and strong, unique passwords on all financial accounts	___ / 5
3	I know my consumer rights and how to formally dispute a transaction	___ / 5
4	I can confidently use digital savings, investment, and payment tools	___ / 5
5	I track my spending and save consistently every month	___ / 5
6	I have active SIM lock, screen lock, and app permission habits	___ / 5
7	My spending decisions align with my stated financial goals	___ / 5
8	I can calculate interest, read financial terms, and support others	___ / 5
TOTAL SCORE		___ / 40

32-40	Digital Finance Champion	Share your knowledge — mentor someone this week.
24-31	Strong Foundation	Identify your two lowest scores and focus there first.
16-23	Growing Confidence	Work through one module of this workbook series per week.
8-15	Starting Point	Begin with Dimension 1 and Dimension 6. Every expert started here.

Next Step

Pick the dimension where you scored lowest. Revisit its section, commit to one action step, and set a reminder to re-score yourself in 30 days.